



Calm Home Skills

Premium practice worksheet

CALM HOME SKILLS - LESSON 05

Prepare for care before the real appointment arrives.

Use this worksheet to help your dog build confidence around exam-style handling, clinic routines, stationing, and recovery so vet visits feel more manageable.

TRAINER NOTE

Vet confidence comes from many small practice moments, not one brave appointment.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner has a short practice plan for exam-style handling and can identify what parts of the vet routine still need to be made easier.

2 Practice plan

1

Build the station

Reward stepping onto and remaining calmly on the practice spot.

2

Pair mock exam touch

Touch easy body parts and feed immediately while the dog remains relaxed.

3

Add mild restraint carefully

Practice a second or two of gentle position support, then release and reward.

4

Generalize slowly

Practice with different people or in different rooms only after easy reps are solid.



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Vet Visit Confidence

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Treats or lick mat
- ☐ Bath mat, platform, or exam-style station
- ☐ Towel or harness if needed for setup
- ☐ A helper if available for mock exam practice

Set up before you start

- ☐ Choose a station such as a mat, table, or low platform.
- ☐ Practice touch to ears, paws, shoulders, and collar area in tiny reps.
- ☐ Keep sessions short enough that your dog stays able to eat and recover.

4 Vet confidence tracker

Date	Station/setup	Handling practice	Response	What helped	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Practicing too long and creating a negative ending.
- Skipping station work and jumping right to handling.
- Trying to work through obvious discomfort.
- Assuming success at home automatically transfers to the clinic.

If this happens, try this

- If the dog leaves the station, reward shorter stays and easier body touches.
- If restraint causes tension, shorten it dramatically and return to easier reps.
- If the dog struggles with helpers, keep one familiar person involved and progress more gradually.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ My dog can stay on the practice station briefly.
- ☐ I can do a few exam-style touches without loss of comfort.
- ☐ I know which handling step is still too hard.
- ☐ I have a simple plan to continue building confidence before the next appointment.

HOMEWORK

Practice three short mock-vet sessions this week. Record the easiest station setup, the body areas that felt easiest, and the first sign that the session should have ended.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____